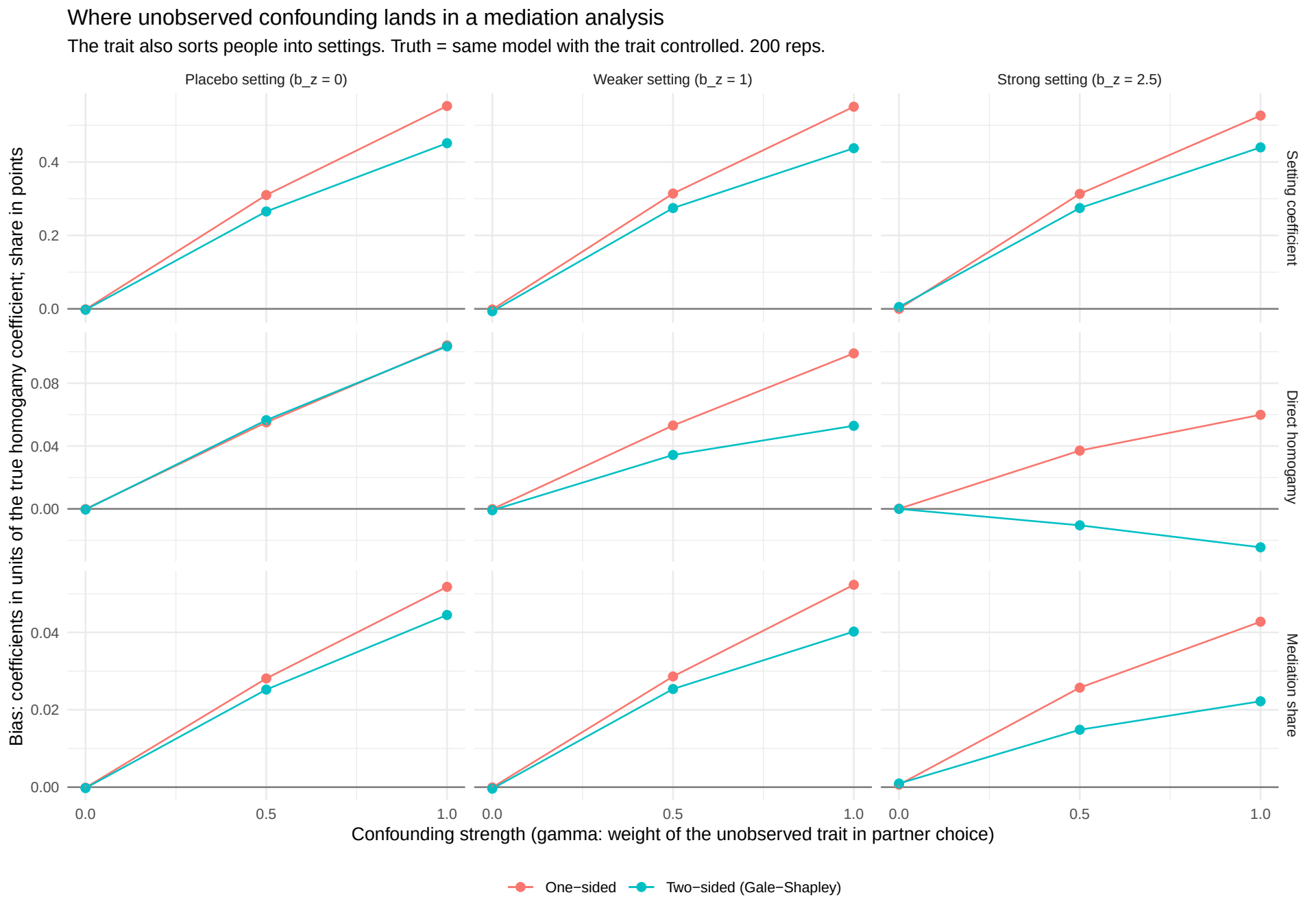
Where unobserved confounding lands in a mediation analysis
The trait also sorts people into settings. Truth = same model with the trait controlled. 200 reps.
Placebo setting (b_z = 0)
Weaker setting (b_z = 1)
Strong setting (b_z = 2.5)
Setting coefficient
Direct homogamy
Mediation share
Bias: coefficients in units of the true homogamy coefficient; share in points
0.4
0.2
0.0
0.08
0.04
0.00
0.04
0.02
0.00
0.0
0.5
1.0
Confounding strength (gamma: weight of the unobserved trait in partner choice)
One−sided
Two−sided (Gale−Shapley)